

PSCI 2223

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Research Report Assignment

Agenda

- Tips on Reading a Research Article
- Research Report Assignment
- Q&A

Reading a Research Article

- Article structure
 - Abstract
 - Everything in a nutshell
 - Introduction
 - Research Question
 - Literature Review
 - Theory and Argument
 - Theory laid out in detail (“I argue ...” or “I expect ...”)
 - Hypotheses
 - Data and Methods
 - How the theory is being tested, what data are being used
 - Analysis and Findings
 - What was found in the testing (“I find ...”)
 - Conclusion

Research Report Assignment

- Citation
- Research Question
- Theory
- Evidence
- Evaluation
- Grammar

Citation

- Full citation to start the paper
- MLA format
 - Arias, Sabrina B. "Who securitizes? Climate change discourse in the United Nations." *International Studies Quarterly* 66.2 (2022): sqac020.
- APA format
 - Arias, S. B. (2022). Who securitizes? Climate change discourse in the United Nations. *International Studies Quarterly*, 66(2), sqac020.

Research Question

- In your own words, explain what the authors are investigating (1-2 paragraphs)
 - How would you put Arias' question into your own words?
- Helpful questions to consider
 - What are the authors investigating?
 - Why is this question interesting to the authors?
 - Why is this question important, according to the authors?

Introduction

Why are some issues in international politics discussed as security matters while others are not? When and why do states make the political decision to frame issues as security concerns? The outcomes of these strategic discursive moves by states have substantial implications for the nature of pol-

Theory

- In your own words, explain what the authors' argument is (2 paragraphs minimum)
 - How would you put Arias' argument into your own words?
- Helpful questions to consider
 - What do the authors believe is the answer to the research question?
 - Why do the authors believe their theory is the answer to the research question?

However, which states *are* expected to act as securitizing actors? I argue, per the theory of agenda-control securitization outlined above, that states that would gain agenda control from securitizing would be more likely to make securitizing moves, while states that would lose agenda control would be less likely to make securitizing moves. Members of the UNSC, particularly the P5 states, stand to gain agenda control, while non-UNSC states stand to lose. These expectations are constant across issue areas. However, the theory also predicts that states for whom the issue is extremely materially important—for whom it may represent an existential threat—are even less likely to securitize, and this depends on the issue at hand. Thus, understanding state preferences on the specific topic of climate change is crucial.

Evidence

- In your own words, explain what kind of evidence the authors use to evaluate their argument (2 paragraphs minimum)
 - How would you describe this evidence in your own words?
- Helpful questions to consider
 - Broadly speaking, what kind of analysis is being used (statistical analysis, network analysis, text analysis, etc.)? What countries are included? What is the time period covered by the data?
 - If a survey was used, how many people were included and is the survey nationally representative? How was the survey carried out?
 - What are the authors' findings?

To test these hypotheses, I deploy new data to look for securitization in a more likely and conceptually appropriate setting—the UNGA—than has previously been examined. I examine whether securitization has occurred and then test my theoretical predictions that P5 states but not SIDS act as securitizing actors on climate change.

I utilize the data collected by [Baturu, Dasandi, and Mikhalylov \(2017\)](#), which consists of all speeches given by state representatives in the General Debate from 1970 to 2014. Not only are speeches good indicators of country preferences and priorities ([Baturu, Dasandi, and Mikhaylov 2017, 3](#)), by securitizing issues, they also perform an agenda-setting function. Each year at the opening of the UNGA in September, the General Debate gives the opportunity for each state to speak in a largely unconstrained setting ([Smith 2006](#)). Allocating the scarce resource of speech time to discuss a given issue is a signal that a country considers it to be of great importance.⁷ These data comprise 7,897 speeches and 205,913 distinct speech segments, which are analogous to paragraphs. In a given year, there are an average of thirty-two segments per speech. I filter this full corpus of speeches based on a set of key terms to obtain only the segments that discuss climate change. This procedure results in a subset of 4,525 relevant speech segments

Evaluation

- In your own words, are there some parts of the argument that are not supported by the evidence? Are there other strengths or weaknesses? What do the authors do well and what can be improved? What other critiques can you offer? (2-3 paragraphs minimum)

Grammar

- Is your research report readable? Can someone, who is not you, read your report and understand what you are saying?
- Helpful tips to consider
 - Read your research report aloud
 - Complete your report ahead of time and reread it later
 - Have someone else read it

Last Considerations

- Research Report due **October 17**
- Length: 1,500-1,800 words
- Avoid direct quotes
- This assignment will receive the **grade of zero** if the article has not been previously approved

Questions?
